



Frequently Asked Questions

What is a scholarship?

A scholarship is a financial award for a student to further their education and is not required to be repaid. This scholarship is privately funded, meaning it does not come from the government, colleges or universities. This scholarship is intended to be added to other financial supports you receive.

What is a dependent scholarship program?

A dependent scholarship program is designed for our employees' dependents (biological, step- or legally adopted children living in the employee's household or primarily supported by the employee) who plan to pursue higher education at an accredited two- or four-year college/university or technical/vocational program for the entire upcoming academic year.

This program differs from our Tuition Reimbursement Program, which is specifically for our employees pursuing a degree in support of their career growth.

How many new awards will be granted each year?

Every year, Fellowes will grant up to three new scholarship awards – one \$10,000 award to underwrite the costs of a four-year college/university and up to two \$2,500 awards to underwrite the costs of a one- or two-year college or vocational/technical school.

Awards are for qualified education-related expenses, including tuition, fees, books and required supplies/equipment.

All awards are eligible for renewal on the basis of satisfactory academic performance maintaining a cumulative grade point average of 3.0 on a 4.0 scale, full-time enrollment and continued parental employment.

Are students entering community college or a technical/vocational program eligible to apply for this scholarship program?

Yes! This program is designed to underwrite the costs of a full-time course of study at an accredited two- or four-year institution or technical/vocational program.

Are students entering a master's degree program eligible to apply for this scholarship program?

No. This program is designed to underwrite the costs of an undergraduate or technical/vocational degree.

Is my second-, third- or fourth-year college student eligible to apply for this scholarship program?

Yes! Current second-, third- and fourth-year students are eligible to apply and re-apply throughout their educational career.

If my dependent completed their first two years of higher education at a community college and will now be enrolling in a four-year institution for their last two years, are they eligible to apply?

Yes! Your dependent would be eligible to apply for the \$10,000 award granted to underwrite the costs of a four-year college/university.

If my dependent has taken college-level courses in high school or is enrolled in full-time Post-Secondary Enrollment Options (PSEO), are they eligible to apply?

Yes. Students that have taken college-level courses or are/were enrolled in full-time Post-Secondary Enrollment Options (PSEO) as part of their high school curriculum are eligible to apply.

If my dependent applies and does not receive this award, are they eligible to re-apply?

Yes! Current students are eligible to re-apply each year.

If my dependent took time off after receiving their high school diploma/GED, are they eligible to apply?

Yes. Applicants aged 25 and under with gap time after receiving a high school diploma/GED are encouraged to apply.

If my dependent receives a scholarship award in their first year, do they need to reapply in order to receive scholarship awards for each following year of undergraduate study?

No. If eligible, these awards are auto-renewable and do not require re-applying each year.

The \$10,000 award is renewable up to three years or until a bachelor's degree is earned.

The \$2,500 award is renewable up to one year for students enrolled in a two-year program.

Each scholarship award recipient eligible for renewal will automatically receive their renewable award each year, so long as they maintain satisfactory academic performance (maintain a GPA of a 3.0 on a 4.0 scale or its equivalent), maintain full-time enrollment and parental employment continues.

What if my dependent falls below the minimum 3.0 GPA threshold to maintain the scholarship award through their undergraduate study?

If a student falls below a 3.0 cumulative GPA, Fellowes will review the student's case for award renewal.

I am a Director-level employee. Is my dependent eligible to apply for this program?

No. As this program is, in part, focused on helping to overcome financial and other personal non-academic barriers, this benefit is only available for employees at the Sr. Manager and below levels. Dependents of Officers, Executives, Senior Directors and Directors are ineligible for this program.

Will my dependent continue to receive the renewable scholarship awards if I voluntarily resign from my position at Fellowes during the school year?

Award recipients of employees who voluntarily resign or are involuntarily terminated for reasons beyond a position elimination or reduction in force during the dependent's academic career may not be eligible for a renewal award.

Will my dependent continue to receive the renewable scholarship awards if my performance drops below a rating of "S" or I am put on a performance improvement plan?

Award recipients of employees whose performance drops below a rating of "S" or are put on a performance improvement plan and/or receive documented corrective action during dependent's academic career may not be eligible for a renewal award.

My dependents' immigration/citizenship status is complicated. Can they apply?

It depends on your specific status. Please contact the Scholarship America Customer Service team at fellowes@scholarshipamerica.org or by phone at 507-931-1682.

If my dependent has issues with their application or award receipt, who should we contact?

Please contact the Scholarship America Customer Service team at fellowes@scholarshipamerica.org or by phone at 507-931-1682.

Can I apply for other scholarships not affiliated with Fellowes?

Yes! You can apply for as many scholarships as you are eligible for. There is no limit. Scholarships are awarded independently, so applying for multiple does not decrease your chance for any individual scholarship. You can be awarded more than one scholarship.

Where can I access resources for choosing a college, navigating financial aid, finding a scholarship and similar topics?

Visit scholarshipamerica.org and navigate to "Students" and "Resources" to access a variety of documents to assist you with these topics.